

EPISODE 7 (SESSION 1)

The Preface

PRIMARY TEXT: Review Genesis 1–11

You've made it, hopefully with a group journeying alongside you, to Episode 7—the Preface of this long, beautiful, and sometimes quite difficult story. We have a new perspective to grapple with. A new set of lenses to juggle. So many chiasms and poems and contexts and purposes—just here in the beginning!

Some hard conversations...

Some Textual wrestling matches.

Some tears shed.

Some blood pressure rising.

Some *very* uncomfortable growing pains.

So many questions. Answered with... even more questions.

So many “aha” moments.

So many long pauses—encouraging and desperate.

That's okay! It's good!

Trust the process and the journey you're on, along with the Story.

Where does humanity go from here? How does God move and act? Why, and why not? What was God thinking?! Keep the questions coming.

**Trust the process
and the journey
you're on, along
with the Story.**

**That is what we
seek. To love God.
To love others. To
become people of
the Text.**

We are just breaking in the spine of this story. So many characters to meet again—or possibly even for the first time. So many bedtime or Sunday School stories to revisit, and others we never realized existed before. These new lenses will ultimately lead to even more wrestling and questions and, hopefully, a deeper, more intimate relationship with Jesus and the Text. That is what we seek. To love God. To love others. To become people of the Text.

As the journey speeds up and we press on through the first few chapters of the next part of the narrative, don't forget to look back at where we started—in the Preface. To look back to the start of this journey that began in a world that was formless and empty, yet out of it came something so very good. Remember that this beginning points at a treasure itself. Rest and comfort.

**Remember that
this beginning to
the Story points at
a treasure itself.**

**...find yourself
at the center
of the chiasm
of comfort.**

So when the questions feel too big, the conversation gets heavy, or you're feeling yourself lose the plot of the Story, remember to wander back to the beginning. To let yourself be held within the pages at the center of the Preface—in the chiasm of comfort.

PRAYER

*God,
As we wake up each morning,
in the face of our chaos or worries or fears,
may we accept your invitation to stop creating, and rest.
May we accept your invitation to stop destroying, and rest.*

*May we reject the cycle of vengeance.
Reject the need for empire and power.*

*And may we accept your invitation to trust.
Trust that creation is good.
Trust that Your Word is enough.
Trust the Story.*

Amen

THE FOUR PILLARS

EPISODE 7

BEMA Discipleship is built on four pillars; a **Four-Pillared Perspective** to help us remember to **elevate the words of God** (not ours) and help us identify the principles that we see recurring in the Story of God's people.

Here are some applications for this episode echoing the ideas of the four pillars:



TEXT

What parts of Genesis 1–11 have you been meditating over as you've listened to these episodes? What Text could you continue to meditate on, memorize, or dig deeper into?



COMMUNITY

How has the Preface changed, challenged, or encouraged the relationship and type of community you find yourself in? What beliefs or ideas about community do you hold to that embrace the challenges in Episodes 1–7?



DISCIPLESHIP

Who in your life could you still invite on this journey with you? Who would benefit from seeing God and the Text through this lens? How do you model the wrestling of the Text with those who need to see that doing so is okay?



WRESTLING

What questions do you have after this lesson? About passages that were not covered or lingering questions about the Midrash or the cultural context? Questions were/are the point. Try to wrestle with this in community!



Are you a music listener?

Listen along to our BEMA Music Playlists on Spotify.

Song suggestions? Send them to bemabesorah@gmail.com.



BEMA SESSION 1



MEDITATION & PRAYER

REFLECTION, APPLICATION & IMPACT

There are three emphases we are always thinking about in terms of application at BEMA. These may be stated explicitly at times, but often we will want you to do the work of finding ways to connect the dots to the things we are learning. Much of this is what makes the work of BEMA distinct as a ministry of Impact Campus Ministries.

CREATING A SPACE SPIRITUAL FORMATION

Soon in Session 1 you will encounter the idea of “Creating Space for God” in our lives. We believe that **if we do our part of creating that space, God will fill it** as He desires. We want BEMA to foster practices that enable the Holy Spirit to do a work in and through us all. How can you begin, or how are you now, creating this space after thinking through the Preface of the Text? Is this sacred devotional time, service, small groups, prayer, other spiritual disciplines?

CONSIDERING CAMPUS YOUNG PEOPLE FOCUS

We believe young adults are shaping the future of this world. How could you reframe the questions you ask young adults and college students as they begin their “career paths” or journey to help them trust the Story? In what ways could you come alongside to model and share with them the ideas of Session 1 so far: stop creating, stop destroying, sabbath, etc?

SACRED STATION THEOLOGY OF WORK

This may be about what we do at work—yet it also has to do with how we choose to rest. How we take a break and reset from our job. How it may take advantage of or bring life to others is something that God says is central to our presence in the world. The way we manage employees and interact with customers or coworkers or families says a lot about the God we believe in and what that God believes about humanity. **The work we do every day is sacred. It matters and has the potential to be a constant reminder to us and those around us to lean into the lessons we learn in the Text.**